

face reality®

Understanding Your Skin

If you're a swimmer, your skin has unique challenges, and your acne-clearing journey may look a little different. This handout is designed to help you understand *why* we take a conservative approach to your treatment, and what you can expect while working with us at **Face Reality**.



Why Swimmers Need Special Care

Swimmers are exposed to pool chemicals such as **iodides** and **chlorine**, which can be harsh on the skin. Over time, these chemicals can weaken your skin barrier, leading to:

- Dehydration
- Increased sensitivity
- Dryness or flakiness
- Redness and reactivity

In addition, frequent sun exposure during outdoor swimming can contribute to sunburn and further compromise the barrier. All these factors can make clearing acne a bit more challenging, but not impossible!

Our Approach at Face Reality

At Face Reality, we prioritize **barrier health** above all else. Because of this, our approach to treating swimmers is more conservative and supportive.

In-Clinic Treatments

During each appointment, your acne expert will perform a **skin analysis** to assess your barrier health and determine whether your skin can safely tolerate exfoliation or a full treatment.

If your barrier appears compromised (e.g., if your skin looks sunburned, pink, dry, flaky, or dehydrated), your acne expert may choose to skip exfoliating treatments and instead perform a more restorative and soothing treatment.

Home Care Routine

Your home care plan will be **customized** based on how your skin is responding and how often you're swimming.

- If you're swimming regularly, we will likely remove actives (like exfoliants) from your morning routine to protect your barrier.
- Your evening routine will contain your active ingredients instead, when your skin has time to recover overnight.
- Because we're using actives less frequently, your clearing journey may take a little longer, but this is a necessary step to protect your skin's health while still making progress.

Your Responsibilities as a Client

To help us help you, please:

- Communicate regularly with your acne expert about how often you're swimming or if your routine changes.
- Wear SPF every day, especially while swimming outdoors.
- Make sure you are not swimming after receiving a treatment. We suggest that you schedule your appointment on a day off.

Please note: Face Reality sunscreens are not water-resistant.

Your Acne Expert will recommend acne-safe sunscreens that suit your needs.

Final Thoughts

Your skin has unique needs as a swimmer, and our team at Face Reality is here to guide you every step of the way. With consistent communication, a customized plan, and patience, clear and healthy *skin is still completely possible.*



PRO TIP

To help your sunscreen stay on while swimming, apply a thin layer of **petroleum jelly** over the top. This helps prevent pool chemicals from stripping away your SPF layer.



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